

Yoga Notes

- Meaning & Concept of Yoga,
- Name & description of *Ashtang* Yoga,
- Name & pictures of the yoga postures,
- Surya Namaskar & *Pranayamas*
- Rules Of Longevity (दीर्घजीवन),

MEANING & CONCEPT OF YOGA

Yoga is a Sanskrit term meaning union- a process of uniting oneself with what he is essentially. Every individual is vital part of the whole universe.

The traditional definitions of Yoga are:-

- Shri Madbhagavad Gita presented so may definition

;kxLFk d : dekf.k lX³ R;DRok /ku¥t ;kA
fln;/fln/;k l ek HkROk leRo ;kx mP;rAA %2@48%

Perform action, O Dhananjaya! Being fixed in yoga, renouncing attachments, and even minded success and failure, equilibrium is verily yoga.

cf) ;Drk tgkrhg mHk l dr n'drA
rLekn ;kxk; ;T;Lo ;kx de l dk''k yeAA %2@50%

The one fixed in equanimity of mind frees oneself in this life from vice and virtue alike; therefore, devote yourself to yoga; work done to perfection is verily yoga.

- Maharshi Patanjali Yoga-Sutra describe yoga as a' ;kxf''pRrofRr fujk/kk' means Restraining the mind- stuff (chitta) from taking various forms (vrittis) is yoga. Commentators of yoga sutra text also define **yoga** as a discipline.
- In Yagyavalkya samhita explained very clearly the aim of yoga – l ;kxk ;kx bfr;Drk thokReuk i jekReuk meaning of this To Unite Soul With Super Soul.
- The term yoga is derived from the root 'Yuj' which means Samadhi (Integration). In practice; the word 'Samadhi' also means a deep trance-like state or an absolute of

awareness. It can also be described as the highest control of mind or deepest absorption of the mind. Samadhi is a state of mind which comes in the course of time; leading to the integration of personality. Therefore, yoga essentially means the integration of personality at all possible levels: physical, mental, social, intellectual, emotional, and spiritual.

Personality is a continuum and one part cannot be separated from another. Therefore, what affects one aspect will ultimately affect the other too. Integration means the function of the whole depends on the proper functioning of the different part. For example- Every machine works well when functioning of every part of the machine. Harmonious function depends upon all the parts working together in unison.

Yoga, the concept of integration, or Samadhi has three meanings:

- Bringing different parts together
- Arranging the parts in their proper places and perspectives.
- Governing these parts properly.

The third meaning is the most important and is the main function of integration. Yoga is often translated in English as 'yoking'. But just bringing two bulls together and joining them to a cart would not make them work. They require a carter to guide them. Only then is it possible for the cart to move. This is the idea of integration. We do not always function harmoniously, because we are all disintegrated to a greater or lesser degree, this inborn factors known as 'Kleshas' in yoga, literally, 'irritation' or 'disturbances' To overcome these is the purpose of yoga and so many techniques are advocated to this end in the yogic texts and traditions. We will discuss here the very popular and easily growing path that is known as 'Astang-Yog' (8 folds/limbs of yoga).

ASHTANG YOGA

- YAMA (;e)- Non-Violence(vfg l k), Truth(l R ;), Non-Stealing(vLr ;), Celibacy(cãp ;), Absence of greed(v ifj xg) Principles of harmony with others.
- NIYAMA(fu ; e)- Cleanliness("kkp), Contentment(l rk'k), Austerity(r i), Self-Analysis (Lok/ ; k ;), Surrender to the highest force-"God"(b"oj if. k/kku). Harmony with Self.
- ASANA (vk l u)- Physical posture.
- PRANAYAMA (i k. kk ; ke)-Vital Energy.
- PRATYAHAR (i R ; kgkj)-Withdrawal of Mind/senses.
- DHARNA (/kkj .kk)-Concentration; Focusing the Mind.

- DHYANA (/;ku)-Deep Contemplation
- SAMADHI (l ekf/k)-Merger in Cosmic Consciousness.

Every society requires rules of conduct to ensure that its members live good, productive lives and cause no harm to, or not harmed by any individual. However, yoga goes further by maintaining that negative attitudes as a whole are harmful to oneself and other people and that one cannot achieve integration without changing them. Yamas are forms of attitude training through the ethical commitment to self, and Niyamas, self discipline.

Asanas are the postures, or held positions, which have evolved from the basic concept of learning to sit still for meditation. The word 'asana' is derived from the Sanskrit root 'as' which actually means 'to sit'. In Yogasutras Maharshi Patanjali considers Asanas to be the third step of his system of Astang-Yoga, he has been define as a 'Sthira-Sukham-Asana' - Sthira, meaning stable, refers to the physical aspect of asana: Sukham to the mental aspect, but when they are both used together, as in this sutra, it implies that it is a psycho-physical process. Therefore, the general belief that the Asanas, or postures, are only physical is wrong. Asana starts with the body, but the purpose of Asana is to train the mind. "Mens sana in corpora sano" means a sound mind in a sound body.

ASANAS

I am sharing with you the Name & pictures of the yoga postures. This is the best way to teach correct yoga practice. Yoga Asanas are completely based up upon our backbone. Asanas make our spine flexible and straighten, through the practice of forwarding, backward, twisting, and stretching Asanas. These are scientifically designed. Common benefits of Asanas are given below:



- MAKE IT FLAXIBAL AND STRONG
- PREVENT BACKACHE & HEADACH
- ASANA TEACH US HOW TO SIT ERRECT
- ENERGY ACCUMULATED RATHER THAN SPENT
- INTERNAL ORGANS ESPECIALLY GLANDS
- EFFECT PHYSICAL AS WELL AS MENTAL
- NO FATIGUE, CRAMPS, HEART STRAIN
- MAIN EFFECTS ON

Asanas are classified in four positions –standing, seating, supine and prone position. I am starting with the same sequence.

STANDING ASANAS

Tadasana



TADA ASANA/ PAD-HAST ASANA

Benefits and limitation

1. It is beneficial in indigestion, stiffness of spine, pain in hip – joints and breathing problems.
2. Reduces fat on the belly & stomach problems.
3. Those suffering from high blood pressure, heart disease and acidity, should not practice it.

Padhastasana



TRIYAK ASANA



TRIKONA ASANA



Benefits and limitations

1. Helps in preventing flat foot.
2. strengthens the Calf and thigh muscles, corrects curvatures of back,
3. Strengthens the waist muscles, reduces fats and makes the spine flexible.



NATRAJ ASANA

Benefits and limitations

1. strengthens the Calf and thigh muscles,
2. Improves balancing neuro - muscular system and concentration

VRIKSHA ASANA



SEATING ASANAS



JANUSHIRASANA

PASHCIMOTTANASANA

• Benefits and Limitations:-

1. This asana strengthens the abdominal muscles.
2. It removes constipation, dyspepsia and seminal weakness.
3. It removes the possibilities of sciatica.
4. Useful in removing fat on the upper portion of the belly, loss of appetite, stiffness of spinal cord, disorders of euro-genital system.
5. Management of prolepses and menstrual disorders, sluggish liver, diabetes, colitis, kidney complaints, bronchitis and eosinophilia.
6. Those suffering from ulcer in abdomen should not practice it.



GOMUKH ASANA

FRONT

BACK



• Benefits and Limitation:-

1. It reduces filthy sexual thoughts, induces relaxation, stimulates kidney, alleviates diabetes.
2. removes pain in hip and lower extremities. Relives from sciatica, backache, rheumatism and stiffness in shoulders and neck, alleviates cramps in legs.
3. making the spine straight.
4. very useful in arthritis and piles (dry)
5. This gives exercise to the lungs.
6. Those suffering from bleeding piles should not practice it



ARDH MATSYENDRA ASANA

- **Benefits and Limitations:-**

1. Useful in loss of appetite, no desire to work, excessive fat in the belly, and formation of chest is not in order, unable to sit erect, weak lungs, weak knee, phurucy.
2. This Asana improves liver efficiency and removes debility of kidney.



USHTAR ASANA

Benefits and Limitations

1. It makes our spine flexible & supple.
2. Increases circulation to the head region.
3. Those who have undergone any recent operation , hernia & hypertension must be cautious .



VAJRA ASANA

- **Benefits and Limitations:-**

1. This strengthens thigh muscles and calf muscles.
2. Useful in hyperacidity, peptic ulcer, hydrocele, dilated testicles in man, hernia and weakness of pelvic region.
3. Persons suffering from piles should not practice it.



SHASHAK ASANA

- **Benefits and Limitations:-**
 1. Alleviates from fat over the belly.
 2. Alleviates weak throat, weak memory, tonsillitis.
 3. Remove trouble of thyroid and para- thyroid glands.

SUPINE POSITION ASANAS



PAWAN MUKTA ASANA

- **Benefits and limitations:-**
 1. Pawan – Muktasana helps to bring out all the gases.
 2. very beneficial effect on the digestive system.
 3. It helps to remove constipation and the extra fat accumulated in the stomach region.
 4. It helps to loosen all the joints of the body and eliminates the foul air and other undesirable elements trapped in them.



NAUKA ASANA

- **Benefits and limitations:-**
 1. its balance the naval dislocation.
 2. Reduces the bally fats.



SARVANG ASANA

Benefits and Limitations:-

1. Stimulates thyroid, Para-thyroid, and thymus glands, enrich blood flow to brain, and tranquillizes the mind.
2. Relieves mental and emotional stress, induces sleep, boosting the immune system.
3. Ensures normal bodily growth, regenerate bones, prevents premature calcification.
4. Disease like dyspepsia, constipation, hernia and visceroptosis can be treated by it.
1. Those suffering from high-blood pressure should not practice it.



MATSYA ASANA

This enhances the benefits achieved through Sarvang asana.



HALA ASANA

Benefits and Limitation:-

1. Due to the disturbance of abdominal muscles there is a complaint of Dyspepsia or constipation it can be corrected by the practice of this Asana.
2. useful in certain types of diabetes and liver problems.
3. Those suffering from cervical spondylitis or stiffness in spine should practice it very carefully.



PRONE POSITION

BHUJANG ASANA

Benefits and Limitations:-

1. This effects the muscles deeply.
2. Useful in abdominal weakness, menses troubles. This is beneficial in flatulence after meal.
3. This asana relocates slipped disc, removes
4. backache, keep the spine supple and healthy, tones ovaries and uterus, stimulates appetite, removes constipation.
5. Massages adrenal gland and stimulates it so useful in high blood pressure, regulates secretion of cortisone and thyroid gland.
6. It is more effective for Asthma, Dyspepsia and Vata diseases and helps

SHALABH ASANA

Benefits and Limitations:-

- 
1. This strengthens the muscles of lower abdomen.
 2. Useful in backache, mild sciatica, slipped disc, stimulation of whole autonomic nervous system and para sympathetic outflow.
 3. This gives strength to the lungs.
 4. Those suffering from high blood pressure, heart disease or having complaint of asthma, should not practice it.

DHANURA ASANA



DHANURA ASANA

Benefits and Limitations:-

1. It makes spine and back muscles flexible,
2. removes nervous weakness.
3. It helps in removing constipation and pitta disorder.
4. Reduces excessive fat around abdominal area,
5. massages kidneys, improve digestive functioning
6. Relives various chest ailments including asthma
7. Those suffering from lumber spondilitis should not practise it.

VIPRIT NAUKASANA

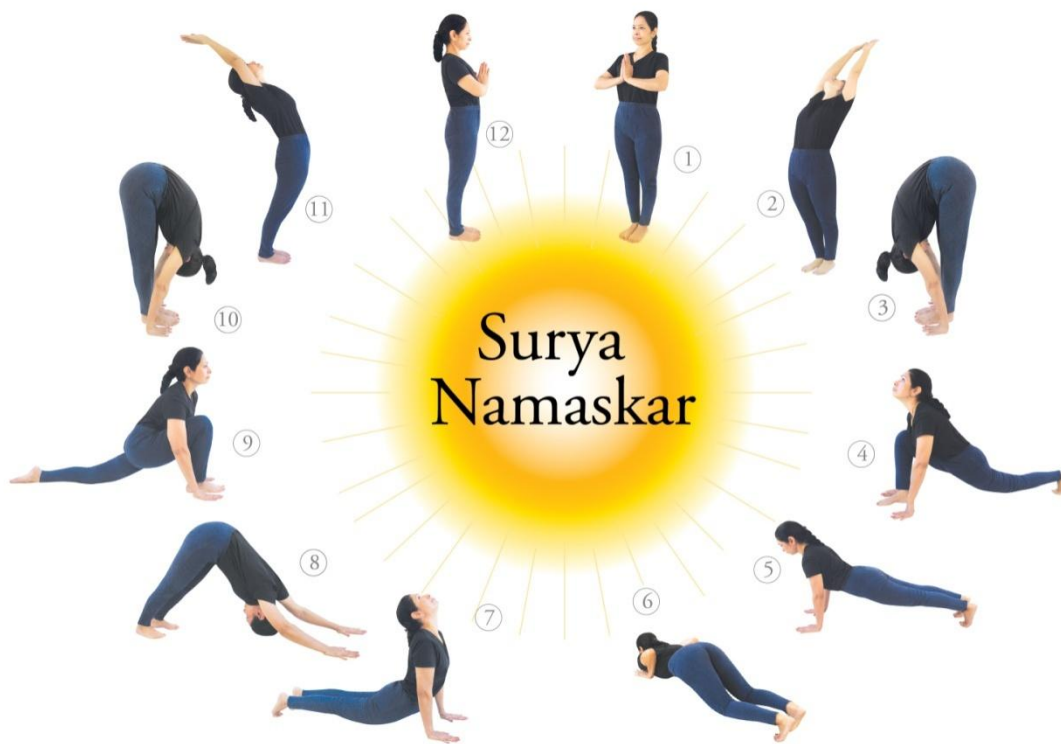
• Benefits and limitations:-

1. its balance the naval



Surya Namaskar or Sun Salutation

Surya Namaskar literally means ‘salute to Sun God.’ It is an expression of gratitude to the Sun God for providing light and prosperity. The ancient yogis practiced it every early morning facing the sun, to greet the Sun God and the new day. Surya Namaskar, is not an asana, it is a scientific warm up that prepares mind and body for asana practice. Each position is synchronized with gentle and graceful movements and specific breathing to improve alertness and remove lethargy.



Instructions for Practice

1. **Om Mitrāya Namaḥ** (ॐ मित्राय नमः; ue½) Pranamasana: Exhale, stand upright, with your hands in prayer position. Steady your body, fix your eyes and look forward and breathe evenly.
2. **Om Rāvaye Namaḥ** (ॐ रावये नमः; ue½) Hasta Uttanasana: Inhale, raise your hands up, gently bend backwards. Look upwards and breathe.
3. **Om Sūryāya Namaḥ** (ॐ सूर्याय नमः; ue½) Pada Hastasana: Exhale, bend forward, press your palms on the sides of your feet. Look downward and breathe.
4. **Om Bhānave Namaḥ** (ॐ भानवे नमः; ue½) Ashva sanchklana Asana: Inhale, stretch your right leg far behind. With support of your hands, arch your spine. Look upwards and breathe.
5. **Om Khagāya Namaḥ** (ॐ खगाय नमः; ue½) Dand Asana: Exhale, take your left leg far behind, adjust and stretch. Look downwards and breathe.
6. **Om Puṣṇe Namaḥ** (ॐ पुष्णे नमः; ue½) Ashta Anga Namaskara: Inhale, bring toes under, knees down, hips up. Exhale, chest and chin down. Look downwards and breathe.
7. **Om Hiraṇya Garbhāya Namaḥ** (ॐ हिरण्यगर्भाय नमः; ue½) Sarpa Asana: Inhale, raise your head and chest, lift your thighs and pelvis off the floor. Stretch and look upwards and breathe.

8. **Om Marīcāye Namaḥ** (ॐ ऐं ह्रीं ऋं) Parwat Asana: Exhale, press your palms and feet, raise your hips and stretch your legs and hands. Lower your head. Look downwards and breathe.
9. **Om Adityāya Namaḥ** (ॐ वृं ह्रीं ऋं) Ashva sanchalan Asana: Inhale, bring your right foot forward between your palms. Stretch your back leg. Arch your spine. Look upwards and breathe.
10. **Om Sāvitre Namaḥ** (ॐ इं ह्रीं ऋं) Pada Hastasana: Exhale, bring your left foot forward, bend forward, stretch your legs and hands. Lower your head and look downwards and breathe
11. **Om Arkāya Namaḥ** (ॐ वृं ह्रीं ऋं) Hasta Uttanasana: Inhale, roll up, bend backward. Look upwards and breathe
12. **Om Bhāskarāya Namaḥ** (ॐ ह्रीं ह्रीं ऋं) Pranamasana: Exhale, stand upright, with your hands in prayer position. Look inwards and breathe.

Benefits: Improves awareness, increases flexibility and strength, relieves lethargy and tensions, reduces weight, and enhances agility and grace.

PRANAYAM

PRANAYAM- (Pran + Aayam) – The Vital Energy

ॐ क्लृप्तं नोऽस्मिन् लोकेश्वर !
 एतन्मया प्रणम्यते त्वत्पदं

Whatever in this three worlds (heaven too) is all under the control of Prāṇa.(O Prāṇa) protect us as a mother protect her sons; give us affluence and intelligence.

Our breathing has an important effect on our minds because it is closely associated with our PRANA OR VITAL ENERGY. The word pranayam is formed by two words i.e. **Prana** and **Ayama**. Prana means a subtle life force which provides energy to different organs (including mind) and

also controls many vital life processes (e.g. circulation, respiration etc.). Ayama signifies the voluntary effort to control and direct this prana. Breathing is one of the vital activities governed by prana on a gross level. In yoga sutra Pranayama define as a

रलेतुल्लसत्पदानां वायोरुपशान्तिरप्रानायामः

“Svasa

Prashvasa

Gativicheda

Inspiration

Expiration

Cessation

(All the three phases are controlled.) means Pranayam is cessation of inspiratory and expiratory phases of breathing. Thus technically speaking, the holding of breath is pranayama. Difference between Pranayamic breathing and normal breathing, the answer is that in pranayama inspiration and expiration are slower than normal breathing. In HATH PRADIPIKA explain correlation between breathing and mind as such-

Pky okr py fpRr fu"py fu"py HkorAA

So long as breathing goes on the mind, remains unsteady, become still (it) stops (the mind).

When our breathing is slow long and rhythmic, our minds are calm. when our breathing is rapid and irregular, our minds are disturbed. How to do practice-

;Dr ;Dr R; t}k; ;Dr ;Dr p ij;rA
;Dr ;Dr p c/uh;kno fl)eoklufvfrAA

One should exhale, retain, and inhale in a regulated manner and should in this way attain success (in Pranayama). Through Pranayama certain physiological changes, take place which influence the mind and enable the yogi to experience higher levels of consciousness.

Types of Pranayama

NADI-SHODHAN

Techniques

1. Sit in any meditative posture. Adopt Nasika-mudra.
2. Close the right nostril with the right thumb and exhale completely through the left nostril. Then inhale deeply through the same (left) nostril.
3. Close the left nostril with your ring and little fingers of Nasika-Mudra, release the right nostril. Now exhale slowly and completely through the right nostril.
4. Inhale deeply through the same (right) nostril. Then close the right nostril and exhale through the nostril. This is one round of Nadisuddhi pranayam.
5. Repeat seven rounds.



- Benefits and limitation:-

1. This practice helps to maintain balance between Nadis.
2. If you feel any headache, heaviness of the head, giddiness, uneasiness, etc. it means you are exerting much pressure on the lungs.
3. The first symptoms of correct practice are the feeling of freshness, energy and lightness of the body and mind.

B. SITKARI –PRANAYAMA

Technique

1. Sit in any meditative posture. Place the palms resting on the thighs.
2. Fold the tongue inwards and press the root of the upper palate with the tip of tongue . The folded tongue slightly comes out between the two rows of teeth and provides a narrow opening on both sides.
3. Slowly suck the air in, which enters through the two sides of the tongue, diffuses throughout the mouth and moves down the trachea in to the lungs.
4. Promote kevala-kumbhaka and feel its effects.
5. The warm air is exhaled out slowly through the trachea, and the nostrils and the breath stops automatically. The deep relaxation obtained due to cooling extends the keval-kumbhak .This completes one round of Sitkari Pranayam.
6. The deep relaxation obtained due to cooling extends the keval-kumbThis completes one round of SitkariRepeat five to seven round.

SHITALI PRANAYAM

SHITKARI PRANAYAM



C. BHRAMARI – PRANAYAM

Technique

1. Sit in any meditative posture. Close your eyes. Place the palms resting on the ground.
2. Slowly raise your both hands, and close your ears with the help of respective thumbs. Keep your fingers above the eyes.
3. Inhale deeply.
4. Exhaling, produce a low pitched sound resembling the humming of a female bee.
5. Feel the vibrations in the entire head.
6. This is one round. Repeat 5 to 9 rounds.



BHRAMARI PRANAYAM

RULES OF LONGEVITY (दीर्घजीवन)

Secrets for a long life:-

1. Adequate physical labor.
2. Eating as soon as one feels hungry.
3. Going to sleep as soon as one feels sleepy.
4. Regularity in yoga practices, meditation.
5. Fasting at intervals.
6. Performing vyapak sauch (व्यापक शौच) before meditation, meals and sleep.
7. Consumption of curds (yogurt), raw food, sprouted food.
8. Getting out of bed in the brahma muhurtta.(ब्रह्म मुहूर्त)

It is necessary for all of you to prepare the above notes before Yoga Practical. This will help you in health improvement along with ease of practical.

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